

SAVE THE BIOSPHERE AND YOU MAY SAVE THE WORLD

HUMAN ACTIVITY AND BIODIVERSITY

IN CONTEXT

KEY FIGURE

Edward O. Wilson (1929–2021)

Georgina Mace (1953–2020)

BEFORE

1964 The International Union for Conservation of Nature's Red List of Threatened Species is established.

1996 *The Song of the Dodo* by David Quammen explores the nature of evolution and extinction as habitats become more and more fragmented.

AFTER

2014 *The Sixth Extinction* by Elizabeth Kolbert shows how humans are causing a sixth mass extinction of species.

2016 In *Half-Earth*, Edward Wilson proposes saving Earth by dedicating half of it to nature.

2020 In *Nature*, scientists highlight the need to address human consumption and production patterns in order to halt biodiversity decline.

Biodiversity is the variety of life on Earth—in all forms and at every level, from genes to microbes to humans and all other species, including those yet